48. The Basque people who are frequently in the news for their separatist activity live in.

(a) France (b) Italy
(c) Portugal (d) Spain

Ans. (d) : The Basque people live in the north central Spain and frequently in news for their separatist activity in Spain.

49. Which one of the following countries is land locked?

(a) Bolivia (b) Peru
(c) Suriname (d) Uruguay

Ans. (a) : The countries which are surrounded by land from four directions are called landlocked countries. Bolivia is a landlocked country in South America. Bolivia is surrounded by Peru, Brazil, Paraguay, Argentina and Chile. Brazil is the largest country in South America in terms of area and French Guyana is the smallest country. Kauru is the launch site in French Guiana.

50. Which one of the following countries does NOT border the Caspian Sea?

(a) Armenia (b) Azerbaijan
(c) Kazakhstan (d) Turkmenistan

Ans. (a) : Russia Azerbaijan, Tajikistan Iran and Kazakhstan are bordered by the Caspian Sea.
The border countries of Armenia - Azerbaijan, Georgia, Turkey.

51. Among the following which planet takes maximum time for one revolution around the Sun?

(a) Earth (b) Jupiter
(c) Mars (d) Venus

Ans. (b) : Jupiter takes maximum time for one revolution around the sun.

INDIAN CONSTITUION & POLITY

52. The Ninth Schedule to the Indian Constitution was added by

(a) First Amendment
(b) Eighth Amendment
(c) Ninth Amendment
(d) Forty Second Amendment

Ans. (a) : First constitutional amendment, 1951, included Ninth Schedule in constitution of India, which provided that by incorporating any law into it, the state would make it immune from Judicial scrutiny. It provided for validation of certain acts and regulations, mostly relating to land reform.

53. Consider the following statements:

1. The joint sitting of the two houses of the Parliament in India is sanctioned under Article 108 of the Constitution.

2. The first joint sitting of Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha was held in the year 1961.

3. The second joint sitting of the two Houses of Indian Parliament was held to pass the Banking Service Commission (Repeal) Bill.

Which of these statements is correct?

(a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 and 3
(c) 1 and 3 (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (d) : The joint sitting of the Parliament is called by the President (Article 108) and is presided over by the Speaker or, in his absence, by the Deputy Speaker of the Lok Sabha or in his absence, the Deputy-Chairman of the Rajya Sabha. The first joint sitting was held on 6 May 1961 following a disagreement between the two Houses over certain amendments to the Dowry Prohibition Bill, 1959. This was followed by another sitting on 9 May 1961 when the Bill, as amended, was finally passed. Banking service commission repeal act, 1978.

54. Under which Article of the Indian Constitution did the President give his assent to the ordinance on electoral reforms when it was sent back to him by the Union Cabinet without making any changes (in the year 2002)?

(a) Article 121 (b) Article 122
(c) Article 123 (d) Article 124

Ans. (c) : Article 123 of the Constitution of India grants power to the President to promulgate ordinances when either of the two Houses of Parliament is not in session.

55. Which one of the following statements is correct?

(a) Only the Rajya Sabha and not the Lok Sabha can have nominated members.
(b) There is a constitutional provision for nominating two members belonging to the Anglo-Indian community to the Rajya Sabha.
(c) There is no constitutional bar for a nominated member to be appointed as a Union Minister.
(d) A nominated member can vote both in the Presidential and Vice Presidential elections.

Ans. (c) : Nominated members enjoy all powers, privileges and immunities available to an elected member of Parliament. They take part in the proceedings of the House as any other member. They are not entitled to vote in the election of the President of India. But in the election of the Vice-President of India, they have a right to vote. There is no constitutional bar for a nominated member to be appointed as a Union Minister.

56. The power to enlarge the jurisdiction of the Supreme Court of India with respect to any matter included in the Union List of Legislative Powers rests with

(a) The President of India.
(b) The Chief Justice of India.
(c) The Parliament.
(d) The Union Ministry of Law, Justice and Company Affairs.

Ans. (c) : The power to enlarge the jurisdiction of the Supreme Court of India with respect to any matter included in the Union List of Legislative Powers rests with the Parliament.

57. Which one of the following High Courts has the Territorial Jurisdiction over Andaman and Nicobar Islands?

(a) Andhra Pradesh (b) Calcutta
(c) Madras (d) Orissa

Ans. (b) : The Calcutta High Court is the oldest High Court in India. It has jurisdiction over the state of West Bengal and the Union Territory of the Andaman and Nicobar Islands.

58. Under which Article of the Indian Constitution did the President make a reference to the Supreme Court to seek the Court's opinion on the constitutional validity of the Election Commission's decision on deferring the Gujarat Assembly elections (in the year 2002)?

(a) Article 142 (b) Article 143
(c) Article 144 (d) Article 145

Ans. (b) : Article 143 of the Constitution is regarding power of the President to consult the Supreme Court related to a matter of public importance.

59. Consider the following statements:

1. While members of the Rajya Sabha are associated with committees on Public Accounts and Public Undertakings members of committee on Estimates are drawn entirely from Lok Sabha.

2. The Ministry of Parliamentary Affairs works under the overall direction of Cabinet Committee on Parliamentary Affairs.

3. The Minister of Parliamentary Affairs nominates Members of Parliament on Committees, Councils, Board and Commissions etc. set up by the Government of India in the various ministries.

Which of these statements are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 and 3
(c) 1 and 3 (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (d) : The Committee on Public Accounts is the oldest parliamentary committee and was first constituted in 1921. The committee consists of 22 members, 15 members are elected from Lok Sabha and 7 members of the Rajya Sabha are associated with it. The Speaker is empowered to appoint the Chairman of the Committee from amongst its members. The Committee on Public Accounts is constituted by the Parliament each year. Estimates Committee is a parliamentary committee consisting of 30 members elected every year by the Lok Sabha from amongst its members to examine the Budget estimates of the Union Government. No minister shall be appointed as a member of Estimates Committee. Ministry of Parliamentary affairs is entrusted with the responsibility of coordinating, planning and arranging Government business in both the Houses of Parliament. For this purpose, the ministry works under the overall direction of Cabinet Committee on Parliamentary Affairs. The Minister of Parliamentary Affairs nominates Members of Parliament on committees, councils, boards and commissions etc set up by the Government in various ministries. Therefore all the statements are correct.

60. As per Indian Protocol, who among the following ranks highest in the order of precedence?

(a) Deputy Prime Minister
(b) Former President
(c) Governor of a State within his State
(d) Speaker of Lok Sabha

Ans. (c) : Order of precedence is President, Vice President, PM, Governor of State within their respective states, Former Presidents and Deputy PM, Chief Justice of India and Speaker of LS.

61. Which one of the following Articles of the Indian Constitution provides that 'It shall be the duty of the Union to protect every State against external aggression and internal disturbance'?

(a) Article 215 (b) Article 275
(c) Article 325 (d) Article 355

Ans. (d) : If president is satisfied that grave emergency exists whereby the security of India or of any part of the territory thereof is threatened or whether by war or external aggression or armed rebellion, he may by proclaimation made a declaration to that effect in respect of the whole of India or of such part of territory thereof as may be specified in the proclamation.

62. Match List I with List II and select the correct answer using the codes given below the lists:

	List I (Item in the India Constitution)		List II (Country from which)
A.	Directive Principles of State Policy	1.	Australia
B.	Fundamental Rights	2.	Canada
C.	Concurrent List in Union-State Relations	3.	Ireland